

EARTHADVENTURESANDREWGOVANEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, and I've run into a great guy, Andrew Govan, from Earth Adventure Australia, and they're operating out of South Australia. Andrew, welcome to the program. Thank you, Geoffrey.

It's good to meet you. Thanks for coming around. Earth Adventure.

Tell us about this first. You work with Pure SA as well, but first of all, Earth Adventure. It sounds like some wonderful things you're doing with your guests in the South Australian region.

I'll just give some good plugs for South Australia, that we are one of the premier, well, the wine couple of Australia. Earth Adventure also brings in the doing part, so we are out in nature. We have some great activations for people, which are all for beginners, so you don't have to be a superhero to do any of our activities.

Different experiences like kayaking, riding, walking, abseiling or climbing. Fantastic place to be, South Australia. Now, there's been many, many movies filmed in the region, because it's so beautiful, the area there.

I'm thinking of one movie, Gallipoli, was filmed out there in the Flinders Ranges, was it? I know that Gallipoli was, and there are others that are filmed in the outback. There's a picture of Second Valley, which is near Rapid Bay as well, and there's a movie that also finishes on the beach of Second Valley, but there's a big sort of drive down and epic finish down there. So, yeah, South Australia has got amazing scenery, and there is definitely a lot of movies made down there.

Now, what's a couple of your favourite spots? Andrew Govan from Earth Adventure. Tell us about a couple of your magnificent gems that we can highlight here. For me personally, there's, well, the whole Adelaide Hills, it's only 25 minutes from the city centre, and you're in Australian Bush, and there's Waterfall Gully, Mount Moriata, amazing areas to go walking, or Moriata, there's climbing as well.

Probably a great feature is also the Dolphin Sanctuary, so that's meant to be part of the city, and it's 25 minutes from the CBD. It's a very unique area, because it's a dolphin habitat, meant to be one of the only ones in the world that's part of the city. That is so great, how you can be in the CBD in an hour, you're with the dolphins in Adelaide, that's incredible.

Less than an hour, less than half an hour. You can be in the dolphins or on the beach with the dolphins, you can be walking around in the foothills. That's probably one of the, why I travel a lot, but Adelaide's my favourite, and very relaxing, but there's so much to do there.

It's still got that small town, well, a big town, it's a city, but it still has that sort of local feel about Adelaide, doesn't it? Everyone really knows, a lot of people know each other. Yeah, there's that

talk about the five points of separation with people, and in Adelaide it probably goes to two or three. Some good things also, even though since COVID there's been eight new hotel properties, so there's a lot of great history, which is looked after well, well-maintained, so you get to see a lot of our history, but there's also such a new modern feel to Adelaide as well, and obviously it is a contained space, so you do get good relationships with people.

There's a really good hosting culture with people, like all the tour operators, amazing guides, they like to really give service in a very Australian way, so it's not that, it's very family style. Yeah, yeah, and tell us a bit about Pure SA, you're partnered with them, they sound like a, is that part of your group or? Correct, it is, and so the Pure is a bit more regional touring, so it's our up-market product, Earth Adventures, South Australian government have the WOW, the Wildlife Outback and Wine, so Pure SA is that sort of brand where we're in the outdoors, we go and interact with wildlife a lot, and we have a wine experience around lunch, and so it's regional touring, things that make that region unique, that's hence Pure SA, a bit more of sometimes the older market, and then the opposite is Earth Adventure, which is the WOB, which is more Wildlife Outback and Beer, or Jim, so do a bit more active activity, fish and chips on the beach, or picnic lunches, and then finish the day with a beer or a gin. Speaking of wineries, South Australia and Adelaide have some of the best wineries in the entire world, I suppose you can show people around there too? Pure does, all its day tours go to a winery, at least one, but we're not wine experts, we're going there because they have great wine, and we eat there as well, and so we get the experts from that winery, like The Lane or Therenberg or others like that, to give their experience into there, that's not the whole thing about the day, for example we go to a wildlife park called Clearland, we go to The Lane, we go to Harnedorf, we do all the things in Adelaide Hills that make it a unique, wonderful place to be.

I grew up in Australia since I was 14 years old, and one of my favourite things to do in the country was to go out into the wilderness at night, look at the billion stars in the sky, I suppose you can do that with Earth Adventure as well? Yes, 35 years of running business, and I can't remember the exact saying for it now, but this has always been one of our features of being outdoors and camping, or going and doing outdoor experiences in the 90s when we first did ecotourism, taking people out, away from the campfire, and then just sitting, and seeing, even in Adelaide, just over the Adelaide Hills, where you start to lose the light of Adelaide, and just see the Milky Way in its way, and get people to sit there and just be with nature, is definitely one of the really good things about South Australia, because there is so much space where it's not light. It's like the greatest show on Earth, isn't it? Just sitting there with a campfire and under the stars, a glass of wine in your hand, it's a million dollar experience. Yes, definitely, and in the old days we definitely had a lot of port around the campfire, nowadays it's more wines.

It is something where just that whole solitude, being able to be by, connect with nature more visually, but as it gets darker you do get more connected through sound. Even though it's quiet, you can pick up all the little rustles or movements around as well. It's a fantastic experience.

I'm talking with Andrew Govan from Earth Adventure Australia in South Australia. Andrew, how can people find out more about you online, about both you and PureSA? We've got two websites, earthadventure.com.au and the other is puresa.com.au. Thank you so much for being with us on the program, Andrew. If you're going to South Australia, contact Andrew at Earth Adventure Australia and they can sort you out with all sorts of great, fantastic tours.

Thanks, mate. Excellent. Thank you very much, Geoff.

Good to speak with you.